

Panel

W: 40 cm; H: 43 cm

Inv. no. 550

A triangular lathe-turned panel inlaid with darkwood pegs. The octagonal pattern is formed by long diagonal members composed of alternating elongated hexagons and smaller ringed elements known as firakh (sing. farkh, lit. “shoots” of a tree), requiring the craftsman to turn individual members on more than one axis and producing a subtle cranking effect. Additional firakh and square elements serve as interlocking connectors between these zigzagging diagonals, stabilising the composition. The style of joinery and ornament suggests a dating to the late Mamluk or early Ottoman periods.